

Infrastructure Mode

When a wireless network functions in infrastructure mode, every user communicates with the network and other users through an access point; this is the typical way that corporate WLANs work. An alternative is ad-hoc mode, but users would have to switch to infrastructure mode to access a network's printers and servers.

Internet Connection Sharing

Also known as ICS, this is a Windows XP function that lets home or small-office users with networked computers share one Internet connection. One computer with an Internet connection serves as the ICS host for all the computers.

Intranet

An intranet is a restricted-access network that works like the Web but isn't on it. Usually owned and managed by a corporation, an intranet enables a company to share its resources with its employees without confidential information being made available to everyone with Internet access.

IP Address

Internet Protocol address. This address is a 32-bit, unique string of numbers that identifies a computer, printer, or another device on the Internet. The IP address consists of a quartet of numbers separated by periods. Each number can be anything from 0 to 255, for example, 128.128.130.4. An IP address can be either static, meaning it never changes, or dynamic, meaning the address is assigned randomly to a computer for only as long as the Internet session lasts. Dynamic IP addresses are commonly used in large corporations and online services for efficiency.

ISM Band

The 2.4 GHz frequency spectrum is also known as the ISM band. ISM is not actually synonymous with 2.4 GHz, however, it stands for Industrial, Scientific, and Medical, the non-commercial uses